

The first smartphone was ‘Simon’, developed as a concept by IBM in 1992. In addition to the expected ‘smart’ features, it even had a stylus you could use to write stuff on the screen with.

Advances in smartphones went hand in hand with those in PDAs and cellular phones. When a new operating system was developed for a PDA, it was not long before it was available for a smartphone. Today’s smartphones run on Symbian, Palm OS or Windows Mobile.

## 1.3 Mobile Telephony in India

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In the early ‘90s the government liberalised the telecom sector, a blessing for the Indian telecom companies. Operators stumbled over one another to get onto the Cellular bandwagon, and cellular telephony in India hasn’t looked back since.

### Timeline

What follows is a brief sketch of the growth of mobile telephony in India since its inception.

#### 1992

Until 1992, the telecom industry in India was still under strict regulations from the government. In 1992, it was announced that the Telecom sector would be liberalised, allowing private companies to provide telecom services.

#### 1993

The Indian telecom sector receives its first foreign investment—the sum of Rs 20.6 million.

#### 1994/1995

The government granted licenses to set up cellular services in the four metros—Delhi, Mumbai, Kolkata and Chennai. Licenses were granted for 19 more wireless circles in 1995. These services would be provided in a *duopoly*—no more than two operators were to cover the same region.